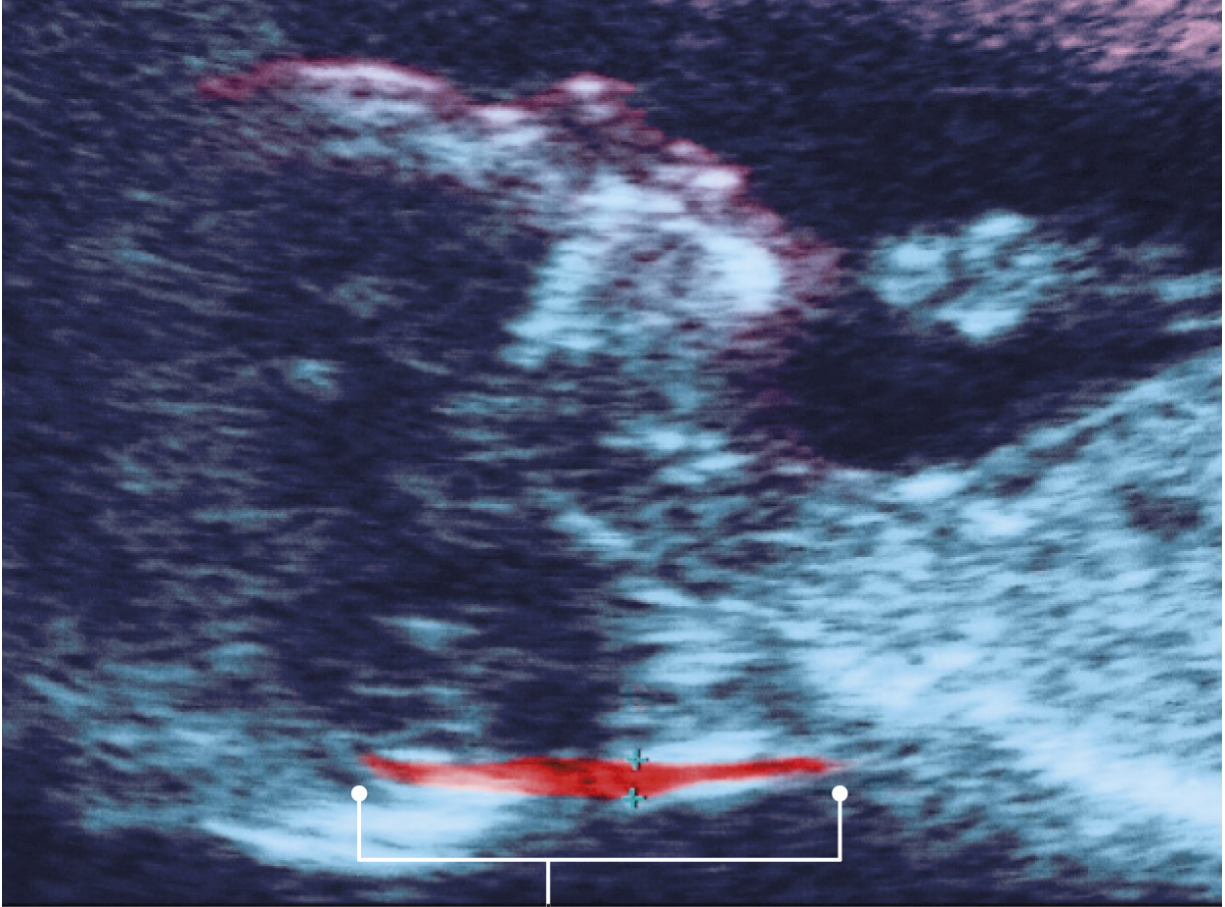




Red area shows the fluid under the skin at the back of the baby's neck

The **nuchal translucency scan** measures the depth of fluid under the skin in the nuchal fold at the back of the baby's neck. Excess fluid increases the chance of the baby having a chromosomal abnormality, such as Down syndrome, or a heart problem. More tests are always needed for a final diagnosis.

HAVING SCREENING AND DIAGNOSTIC TESTS

It's useful to be aware of the screening tests (see [Tests for chromosomal abnormalities](#)) and [diagnostic tests](#) that will be available in the weeks to come.

- **Screening tests:** these tests identify the “risk factor” for a particular condition, but do not confirm that your baby definitely has a condition. For example, a screening test for Down syndrome may give a risk factor of 1:200. This means that your baby has a 1 in 200 chance of being affected by Down syndrome, but it does not mean that the baby actually has the condition.
- **Diagnostic tests:** if screening tests reveal your baby has a high risk factor for a chromosomal abnormality, you will be offered a diagnostic test, such as amniocentesis or chorionic villus